Sumit Nayyar

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Summary

Design Engineer who builds production React/TypeScript and designs the workflows around it for complex, data-heavy B2B software. At Optmyzr, built reusable React components, redesigned onboarding (+25% completion) and led discovery for data integrations (+13% connector additions) on a platform serving 10,000+ advertising accounts. At Groundwork, building an AI-assisted engineering workflow that turns stakeholder context into reviewable pull requests. Also built Tack, a React/TypeScript prototype with Gmail OAuth and two-tier AI safety verification. Holds a double MSc in HCI & Design from Aalto University and the University of Trento.

Experience

Co-founder, Product Engineer (Part-time) — Groundwork, Finland Jun 2025 – Present

- Built an AI-assisted engineering workflow using GitHub Actions and API-based context retrieval to prepare implementation context and open reviewable pull requests.
- Led product discovery and client workshops for an accessibility-focused online learning service; ran usability testing focused on accessibility and turned findings into prioritised build decisions.
- Secured two pilot clients; the venture placed second in EIT Jumpstarter's New European Bauhaus track.

Product Design Researcher, Data Interfaces — Dedanext S.p.A., EDIAQI EU-Horizon collaboration Mar 2026 – May 2026

- Developed a reusable component framework for ambient displays, creating consistent interface patterns across scenarios and sensor-data streams.
- Translated 12+ indoor air-quality sensor streams into a decision-support dashboard and five-state ambient display for teachers and facility staff.
- Tested six display concepts across four data modalities with 200+ participants and used the results to refine information hierarchy.
- MSc thesis examined how air-quality sensor data can become actionable insight for non-technical users.

Design Engineer, Core Systems — Optmyzr Inc., enterprise advertising SaaS May 2020 – Jul 2024

- Built reusable React components within a 30+ component library adopted across five tools by a team of 30+, standardising UI patterns on a platform serving 10,000+ advertising accounts.
- Redesigned onboarding as a five-step configuration wizard, designing the flow and implementing it in React; completion rose 25% over six months.
- Led Data Integrations discovery, interviewed 50+ users and mapped their workflows; presented findings to the team. The work contributed to a 13% increase in connector additions.
- Shipped end-to-end features across React, TypeScript, C#/.NET and SQL, including data integrations with authentication, asynchronous processing and scheduled jobs.

Selected Projects

EDIAQI — Environmental Decision Support Case study

- Designed a decision-support dashboard and five-state ambient display that translated 12+ indoor air-quality sensor streams into guidance for teachers and facility staff. Tested six display concepts with 200 participants and used findings to improve information presentation.

Tack — Spatial Thinking & AI Task Delegation Canvas Live prototype · Work in progress

- Built a React/TypeScript canvas that connects to Gmail via OAuth 2.0 and turns emails into draggable tasks. Its two-tier safety checks filter for meaningful emails before adding them to the board, then ask the user for clarification when a task is ambiguous rather than letting AI invent instructions.

YOU (SuperEgo) — Focus and Habit Assistant Case study

- Prototyped an OS-level assistant that identifies potential distraction patterns, such as rapid app-switching and late-night scrolling, and offers timely nudges to return to a task.

Education

Double-degree MSc, HCI & Design — Aalto University & University of Trento 2024 – 2026

- Focus on interface engineering, usability evaluation, decision-making and user-centred design.

Skills

Frontend	React, TypeScript, JavaScript, HTML/CSS, component architecture, Storybook
AI workflow	Claude Code, GitHub Actions, API-based context retrieval, Gemini API, AI-assisted development
Design	Interaction design, information architecture, usability evaluation, accessibility, rapid prototyping, Figma, design tokens
Data and delivery	REST APIs, GraphQL, C#/.NET, SQL, MongoDB, Git, CI/CD
AI integration	MCP integrations
Accessibility	Accessibility-focused usability testing, WCAG-informed evaluation (no conformance level claimed)
Research and collaboration	User interviews, stakeholder workshops, research synthesis, cross-functional delivery

Languages

English (Fluent) | Punjabi (Native/Bilingual) | Hindi (Native/Bilingual) | Finnish (Basic)